

Abusive behavior

You may not engage in the targeted harassment of someone, or invite other people to do so. We consider abusive behavior an attempt to harass, intimidate, or silence someone else's voice.

Rationale

On Twitter, you should feel safe expressing your unique point of view. We believe in freedom of expression and open dialogue, but that means little as an underlying philosophy if voices are silenced because people are afraid to speak up.

In order to facilitate healthy dialogue on the platform, and empower individuals to express diverse opinions and beliefs, we prohibit behavior that harasses or intimidates, or is otherwise intended to shame or degrade others. In addition to posing risks to people's safety, abusive behavior may also lead to physical and emotional hardship for those affected.

Learn more about our approach to [policy development and our enforcement philosophy](en/rules-and-policies/enforcement-philosophy.html).

When this applies

Some Tweets may seem to be abusive when viewed in isolation, but may not be when viewed in the context of a larger conversation. When we review this type of content, it may not be clear whether it is intended to harass an individual, or if it is part of a consensual conversation. To help our teams understand the context of a conversation, we may need to hear directly from the person being targeted, to ensure that we have the information needed prior to taking any enforcement action.

We will review and take action against reports of accounts targeting an individual or group of people with any of the following behavior within Tweets or Direct Messages. For accounts engaging in abusive behavior on their profile, please refer to our [abusive profile policy](en/rules-and-policies/abusive-profile.html). For behavior targeting people based on their race, ethnicity, national origin, sexual orientation, gender, gender identity, religious affiliation, age, disability, or serious disease, this may be in violation of our [hateful conduct policy](en/rules-and-policies/hateful-conduct-policy.html).

Violent threats

We prohibit content that makes violent threats against an identifiable target. Violent threats are declarative statements of intent to inflict injuries that would result in serious and lasting bodily harm, where an individual could die or be significantly injured, e.g., "I will kill you."

Note: We have a zero-tolerance policy against violent threats. Those deemed to be sharing violent threats will face immediate and permanent suspension of their account.

Wishing, hoping, or calling for serious harm on a person or group of people

We do not tolerate content that wishes, hopes, promotes, incites, or expresses a desire for death, serious bodily harm or serious disease against an individual or group of people. This includes, but is not limited to:

- Hoping that someone dies as a result of a serious disease e.g., "I hope you get cancer and die."
- Wishing for someone to fall victim to a serious accident e.g., "I wish that you would get run over by a car next time you run your mouth."
- Saying that a group of individuals deserves serious physical injury e.g., "If this group of protestors don't shut up, they deserve to be shot."

About wishes of harm exceptions on Twitter

We recognize that conversations regarding certain individuals credibly accused of severe violence may prompt outrage and associated wishes of harm. In these limited cases, we will request the user to delete the Tweet without any risk of account penalty, strike, or suspension. Examples are, but not limited to:

- "I wish all rapists to die."
- "Child abusers should be hanged."

Unwanted sexual advances

While some [consensual nudity and adult content is permitted](en/rules-and-policies/media-policy.html) on Twitter, we prohibit unwanted sexual advances and content that sexually objectifies an individual without their consent. This includes, but is not limited to:

- sending someone unsolicited and/or unwanted adult media, including images, videos, and GIFs;
- unwanted sexual discussion of someone's body;
- solicitation of sexual acts; and
- any other content that otherwise sexualizes an individual without their consent.

Using insults, profanity, or slurs with the purpose of harassing or intimidating others

We take action against the use of insults, profanity, or slurs to target others. In some cases, such as (but not limited to) severe, repetitive usage of insults or slurs where the primary intent is to harass or intimidate others, we may require Tweet removal. In other cases, such as (but not limited to) moderate, isolated usage of insults and profanity where the primary intent is to harass or intimidate others, we may limit Tweet visibility as further described below. Please also note that while some individuals may find certain terms to be offensive, we will not take action against every instance where insulting terms are used.

Encouraging or calling for others to harass an individual or group of people

We prohibit behavior that encourages others to harass or target specific individuals or groups with abusive behavior. This includes, but is not limited to: calls to target people with abuse or harassment online and behavior that urges offline action such as physical harassment.

Denying mass casualty events took place

Abuse and harassment

Overview

June 2023

You may not share abusive content, harass someone, or encourage other people to do so.

On X, you should feel safe expressing your unique point of view. We believe in freedom of expression and open dialogue, and in order to facilitate healthy dialogue on the platform, and empower individuals to express diverse opinions and beliefs, we prohibit behavior and content that harasses, shames, or degrades others. In addition to posing risks to people's safety, abusive behavior may also lead to physical and emotional hardship for those affected.

What is in violation of this policy?

Targeted harassment

We consider targeted behavior as malicious, unreciprocated, and intended to humiliate or degrade an individual(s). We prohibit the following behavior on the platform:

- Sharing multiple Posts, over a short period of time, or continuously posting replies with malicious content, to target an individual. This includes accounts dedicated to harassing an individual or multiple individuals.
- Mentioning or tagging users with malicious content.

Encouraging or calling for others to harass an individual or group of people

We prohibit behavior that encourages others to harass or target specific individuals or groups of people with abuse. This includes, but is not limited to: calls to target people with abuse or harassment online and behavior that urges offline action, such as physical harassment.

Unwanted Sexual Content & Graphic Objectification

While some [consensual nudity and adult content is permitted](http://web.archive.org/en/rules-and-policies/media-policy.html) on X, we prohibit unwanted sexual conduct and graphic objectification that sexually objectifies an individual without their consent. This includes, but is not limited to:

- sending someone unsolicited and/or unwanted adult media, including images, videos, and GIFs;
- unwanted sexual discussion of someone's body;
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- any other content that otherwise sexualizes an individual without their consent.

Insults

We take action against the use of insults or profanity to target others. In some cases, such as (but not limited to) severe, repetitive usage of insults or profanity where the context is to harass or intimidate others, we may require Post removal. In other cases, such as (but not limited to) moderate, isolated usage of insults and profanity where the context is to harass or intimidate others, we may limit Post visibility as further described below. Please also note that while some individuals may find certain terms to be offensive, we will not take action against every instance where insulting terms are used.

Violent Event Denial

Abuse and harassment

Overview

June 2023

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Violent Event Denial

Abuse and Harassment

Overview

March 2024

You may not target others with abuse or harassment, or encourage other people to do so.

X's mission is to give everyone the power to create and share ideas and information, as well as express their opinions and beliefs without barriers. Free expression is a human right – we believe that everyone has a voice, and the right to use it. Our role is to serve the public conversation, which requires representation of a diverse range of perspectives.

We recognize that if anyone, regardless of background, experiences harassment on X, it can jeopardize their ability to express themselves and cause harm. To facilitate healthy dialogue on the platform, and empower individuals to express diverse opinions and beliefs, we prohibit behavior and content that harasses, shames, or degrades others. In addition to posing risks to people's safety, these types of behavior may also lead to physical and emotional hardship for those affected.

What is in violation of this policy?

We prohibit behavior and content that harasses, shames, or degrades others, as defined below. Please note that, in order to help our teams understand the context, we sometimes need to hear directly from the person being targeted to ensure that we have the necessary information prior to taking appropriate and proportionate enforcement action.

Targeted Harassment

We prohibit the malicious, unreciprocated targeting (such as mentioning or tagging) of individual(s), particularly when shared to humiliate or degrade someone. This can mean:

- Sharing multiple Posts, over a short period of time, or continuously posting replies with malicious content, to target an individual. This includes accounts dedicated to harassing an individual or multiple individuals.
- Mentioning or tagging users with malicious content.

We prohibit content that denies that mass murder or other mass casualty events took place, where we can verify that the event occurred, and when the content is shared with abusive **intent**. This may include references to such an event as a "hoax" or claims that victims or survivors are fake or "factors." It includes, but is not limited to, events like the Holocaust, school shootings, terrorist attacks, and natural disasters.

Do I need to be the target of this content for it to be reviewed for violating the [Twitter Rules](#)?

~~No, we review both first-person and bystander reports of such content.~~

Consequences

~~When determining the penalty for violating this policy, we consider a number of factors including, but not limited to, the severity of the violation and on individuals' previous record of rule violations. The following is a list of potential enforcement options for content that violates this policy:~~

- ~~• Downranking Tweets in replies, except when the user follows the Tweet author.~~
- ~~• Making Tweets ineligible for amplification in Top search results and/or on timelines for users who don't follow the Tweet author.~~
- ~~• Excluding Tweets and/or accounts in email or in-product recommendations.~~
- ~~• Requiring Tweet removal.~~
- ~~• For example, we may ask someone to remove the violating content and serve a period of time in read-only mode before they can Tweet again. Subsequent violations will lead to longer read-only periods and may eventually result in permanent suspension.~~
- ~~• Suspending accounts whose primary use we've determined is to engage in abusive behavior as defined in this policy, or who have shared violent threats.~~

~~Learn more about [our range of enforcement options](en/rules-and-policies/enforcement-options.html):~~

If someone believes their account was suspended in error, they can [submit an appeal](<https://help.twitter.com/forms/general?subtopic=suspended>).

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Do I need to be the target of this content for it to be reviewed for violating the X Rules?

To help our teams understand the context, we sometimes need to hear directly from the person being targeted to ensure that we have the necessary information prior to taking any enforcement action. Some Posts may appear to be abusive or harassing when viewed in isolation, but may not be when viewed in the context of a larger conversation. When we review cases, it may not be clear whether the context is to abuse an individual, or if it is Excluding the Posts from having ads adjacent to it

- Making content on X less visible by:
 - Removing the Post from search results, in-product recommendations, trends, notifications, and home timelines
 - Restricting the Post's discoverability to the author's profile
- Downranking the Post in replies
- Restricting Likes, replies, Reposts, Quote, bookmarks, share, pin to profile, engagement counts, or Edit Post
- Excluding the Post from having ads adjacent to it
- Excluding Posts and/or accounts in email or in-product recommendations.
- Requiring Post removal.
- For example, we may ask someone to remove the violating content and serve a period of time in read-only mode before they can Post again.

- Suspending accounts for those whose sole purpose is to violate our Unwanted Sexual Content & Graphic Objectification policy, or accounts that are dedicated to harassing individuals.

Learn more about [our range of enforcement options](<http://web.archive.org/en/rules-and-policies/enforcement-options.html>):

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Incitement of Harassment

We prohibit behavior that encourages others to harass or target specific individuals or groups of people with abuse. This includes, but is not limited to: calls to target people with abuse or harassment online and behavior that urges offline action, such as physical harassment.

Unwanted Sexual Content & Graphic Objectification

While some [consensual nudity and adult content is permitted](<https://help.twitter.com/rules-and-policies/media-policy>) on X, we prohibit unwanted sexual conduct and graphic objectification that sexually objectifies an individual without their consent. This includes, but is not

limited to:

- Sending someone unsolicited and/or unwanted adult media (images, videos, and GIFs)
- unwanted sexual discussion of someone's body
- solicitation of sexual acts
- any other content that otherwise sexualizes an individual without their consent.

Insults

We take action against the use of insults or profanity to target others. However, while some individuals may find certain terms to be offensive, we will not take action against every instance where insulting terms are used.

Use of Prior Names and Pronouns

Where required by local laws, we will reduce the visibility of posts that purposefully use different pronouns to address someone other than what that person uses for themselves, or that use a previous name that someone no longer goes by as part of their transition. Given the complexity of determining whether such a violation has occurred, we must always hear from the target to determine if a violation has occurred.

What is not in violation of this policy?

Some posts may appear to be harmful when viewed in isolation, but may not be when viewed in the context of a larger conversation. For example, friends may consensually use certain terms or phrases to engage with each other that could appear abusive without this context. We also recognise that our platform can be used to call attention to, condemn, or highlight others for harmful behaviors. In such cases, we do not take action where the context is clearly non-abusive and intended to counter these kinds of rhetoric.

We also believe that criticism of institutions, practices and ideas is a fundamental part of the freedom of expression and thus we will not take action on such critical commentary.

Who can report violations of this policy?

Anyone can report violations of this policy using our dedicated reporting flow. However, we sometimes need to hear directly from the person being targeted to ensure that we have the information needed prior to taking any enforcement action.

What happens if you violate this policy?

When determining the penalty for violating this policy, we consider a number of factors including, but not limited to the severity of the violation, whether someone has been targeted (such as being mentioned, referred to by full name, referenced with a photo, etc), and an individual's previous record of rule violations. The following is a list of potential enforcement options for content that violates this policy:

- Making content less visible on X by:
 - Removing the post from search results, in-product recommendations, trends, notifications, and home timelines
 - Restricting the post discoverability to the author's profile
- Downranking the post in replies
- Restricting likes, replies, reposts, quote, bookmarks, share, pin to profile, or engagement counts
- Excluding the post from having ads adjacent to it
- Excluding posts and/or accounts in email or in-product recommendations.
- Requiring post removal.
- For example, we may ask someone to remove the violating content and serve a period of time in read-only mode before they can post again. Subsequent violations may lead to account suspension.
- Suspending accounts whose sole purpose is to violate our Unwanted Sexual Content & Graphic Objectification policy, or accounts that are dedicated to harassing individuals.

To learn more, please see our [range of enforcement options](<https://help.twitter.com/rules-and-policies/enforcement-options>), and if someone believes their account was enforced against in error, they can [submit an appeal](<https://help.twitter.com/forms/account-access/appeals>).